

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8b-36ue-pld1
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: Web

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-8889

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

Artificial Intelligence is not intelligence. It is an aggregator and guesser. AI doesn't create an image, it guesses what image the prompt writer wants based on millions and millions of images it has digested. AI doesn't create a story, it guesses what the next word is in each sentence based on millions and millions of stories it has digested. Most of these images and most of these stories used to train these AIs are stolen.

Perhaps the companies pushing AI (that most people don't even want) thought nobody would notice. The only way for their machine to live is to eat, and rather than pay for its food, these companies are now asking the government to let it eat for free--and not food that's just laying around. They want the government to green light STEALING the work of human creators so their machine can function at extremely low cost.

Let's be clear, while I don't think any artist should ever give permission for their art (broadly speaking, visual media or written stories) to be digested and regurgitated by an AI program, it is within their rights to do so. And there are already plenty of artists doing just that. The problem is, the AI companies would rather not pay for it.

Tough.

AI is having trouble pushing their product because there is a lack of demand. Perhaps they should pivot. Instead, these Silicon Valley welfare queens want to get rich off of the work of real, flesh and blood creators.

The rule of law and government of the United States have always held the rights to real and personal property among its highest values. The broad strokes of copyright law have been settled for decades. But now, a bunch of over-leveraged companies that didn't think through their plan are having trouble moving forward unless they get the government's permission to commit theft in broad daylight. This stands against the law and the values this country has to this point held sacred. The people of the United States owe these AI companies nothing.

They have no right to be preemptively bailed out before they ever even provide a product that anyone wants. The audacity to beg the US government for a special rule that allows them free range through the pages of author's books and the labor of an artists brushstrokes is shocking.

If AI companies can't do it on their own, maybe they should revisit their business plans. Or maybe they should create something people will actually pay for and use.

Denying them the ability to steal the work of others will force them to create a better product or to abandon it. In that case, it wasn't worth it.

Don't be fooled by Silicon Valley parseltongues who use big words you as a legislator don't understand. It doesn't make them smart. Stand up for everyday people who create the books you read, the art you appreciate, and the shows you watch. Demand that AI

companies do it like everyone else when making a product: PAY FOR THE RAW MATERIALS.